

Enhancing Symbolic Execution with Self-Configuring Parameters

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백가현

Parameters in Symbolic Execution

- **Symbolic execution**
 - 프로그램의 입력을 symbolic variable로 두고 여러 실행 경로를 탐색하면서 test case를 생성하는 기법.
- 현대 symbolic execution tools 에는 많은 파라미터가 있고 이러한 방대한 파라미터는 사용자로 하여금 사용을 어렵게 만든다.
 - KLEE 는 148개의 parameter 가 있다.
- Symbolic executor 의 많은 외부 파라미터가 branch coverage와 bug finding 등의 성능에 큰 영향을 준다.

Parasuit

- Parasuit 의 목표:
 - 각각의 프로그램에 대해 자동으로 symbolic execution parameter configuration을 구성.

구분	SymTuner	ParaSuit
파라미터 선택	사람이 미리 선택	자동 선택
후보값	사람이 정의	프로그램별 자동 구성
튜닝 방식	user-configured	self-configuring
한계	fixed search space	실행 feedback 기반 반복 개선

Existing Parameter Tuning Approaches

- **Manual Tuning Approach**

- Boolean, integer, string type 파라미터가 섞여 있고 가능한 조합이 매우 많음.

```
$ klee --simplify-sym-indices=true --max-memory=1000
    --max-static-fork-pct=1.0 --search=random-path
    ... (24 more parameters)
    --max-solver-time=30s --sym-args 0 1 10 --sym-files 1 8
```

(a) Parameter values of KLEE used in [66]

- **User-configured Tuning Approach**

- 사용자가 미리 정한 parameter space 를 입력으로 받고, symbolic execution 을 반복 실행하면서 sampling probability 를 업데이트한다.
- 그러나, parameter space 자체는 사람이 정해야 한다는 한계가 존재한다.

```
"space": {
  "-simplify-sym-indices": [True, False],
  "-max-memory": [500, 1000, 1500, 2000, 2500],
  "-max-static-fork-pct": [0.25, 0.5, 1, 2, 4],
  "-search": ["random-path", ... , "dfs"],
  ... (13 more spaces)
  "-max-solver-time" : ["10s", "20s", "30s", "40s", "50s"],
  "-sym-arg": [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10],
  "-sym-files 1": [4, 8, 12, 16, 20]
}
```

(b) Parameter spaces of KLEE used in [20]

Related Work

- **Enhancing Symbolic Execution**

- Path explosion을 줄이기 위한 search heuristic 연구
- Seed selection, state pruning, concolic testing 등으로 탐색 효율 개선
- 대부분 engine 내부 알고리즘 개선에 초점

- **Tuning External Parameters**

- KLEE/CREST 같은 도구는 많은 외부 파라미터에 민감
- SymTuner는 주어진 후보 공간 안에서 값을 적응적으로 선택
- 하지만 튜닝할 파라미터와 후보 값은 사용자가 미리 정해야 함

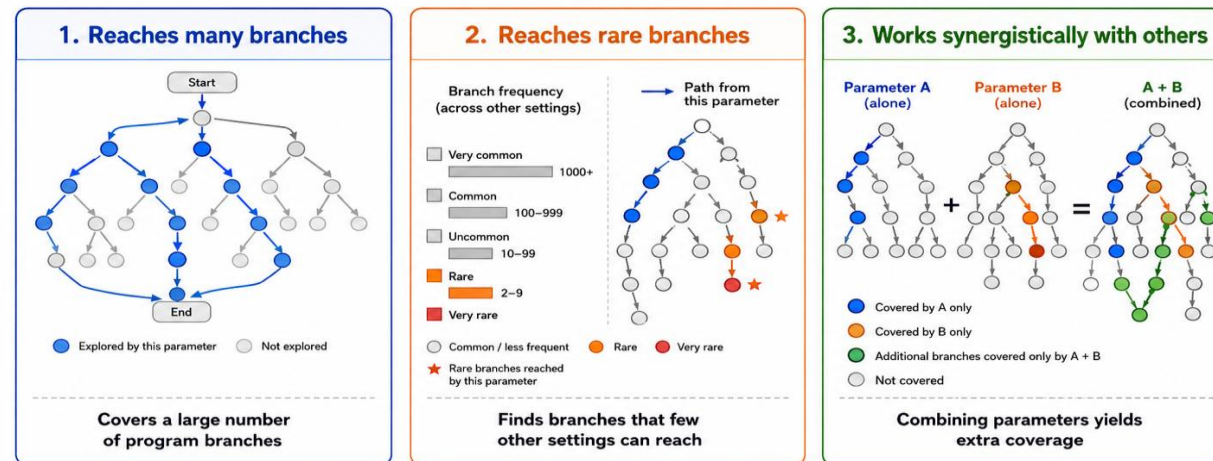
- **Search-based Software Testing**

- Random search, Bayesian optimization, genetic algorithm 등 활용 가능
- 일반 최적화 기법은 symbolic execution 특화 정보가 부족
- ParaSuit는 branch feedback을 이용해 프로그램별 설정을 학습

Design

- **Promising parameter**
 - Reach many branches
 - Cover infrequently reached branches
 - Produce synergy when combined with other parameters
- **Score Function**
 - The number of branches covered when adjusting p
 - Its ability to reach branches that are rarely covered by other parameters

What makes a Promising Parameter?



Promising parameters are those that **cover more branches**, **uncover rare behaviors**, and **complement other parameters**.

PARASUIT

- **Extraction**
 - 심볼릭 실행 도구의 소스코드 AST 및 도움말을 분석하여 모든 가능한 파라미터를 자동 식별
- **Selection**
 - 도달하기 어려운 희귀 브랜치 커버 여부와 파라미터 간의 시너지를 기준으로 점수를 부여
- **Sampling**
 - 프로그램 특성에 맞춰 탐색(Explore) 및 활용(Exploit) 과정을 반복하며 최적 값 도출

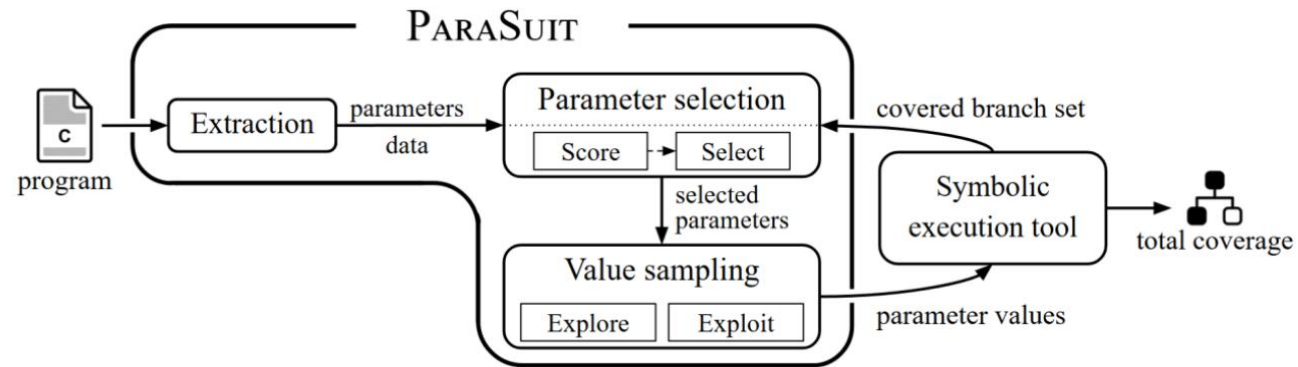


Figure 2: Overview of PARASUIT.

Contributions

- **최초의 완전 자율 튜닝 (Self-configuring)**
 - 사용자 개입 없이, scratch 부터 프로그램 특성에 맞춰 기호 실행 파라미터 최적화
- **맞춤형 탐색 알고리즘 개발**
 - 사전 지식 없이 유효 파라미터를 자동 식별
 - 실행 피드백 기반의 반복적 개선(iterative refinement)으로 최적값 도출

Algorithm 1

- Initialize

	초기화	
D	0	반복 단계에서 축적되는 데이터
BaseD	0	Extraction stage 에서 만든 baseline 데이터
TotalB	0	지금까지 여러 실행에서 나온 branch coverage 결과들의 모음
times	η_{time}	Symbolic execution 한 번에 주는 작은 시간 예산

Algorithm 1 PARASUIT

Input: Program (pgm), time budget ($time$)

Output: A total set of covered branches ($UnionB$)

```

1:  $\langle D, BaseD, TotalB, time_s \rangle \leftarrow \langle \emptyset, \emptyset, \emptyset, \eta_{\text{time}} \rangle$  ▷  $\eta_{\text{time}} = 120$ 
2:
3: /* Step 1. Extraction stage */
4:  $P \leftarrow \text{Initialize}()$  ▷  $(p, v_d, V) \in P$ 
5: for each  $(p, v_d, V) \in P$  do
6:    $PV_d \leftarrow \{(p', v_d) \mid (p', v_d, \_) \in P \wedge (p \neq p')\}$ 
7:   for  $v$  in  $V \setminus \{v_d\}$  do
8:      $PV \leftarrow PV_d \cup \{(p, v)\}$ 
9:      $B \leftarrow \text{EXECUTE}(pgm, time_s, PV)$  ▷  $B = \text{covered branches}$ 
10:     $BaseD \leftarrow BaseD \cup \{(p, v, B)\}$ 
11:     $TotalB \leftarrow TotalB \cup \{B\}$ 
12:
13: repeat
14:   /* Step 2. Parameter selection stage */
15:    $BaseS \leftarrow \{(p, \text{Score}(B, TotalB)) \mid (p, \_, B) \in BaseD\}$ 
16:    $ParamS \leftarrow \{(p, \text{Score}(B, TotalB)) \mid (p, \_, B) \in D\}$ 
17:    $SelectP \leftarrow \text{Select}(ParamS, BaseS)$ 
18:
19:   /* Step 3. Value sampling stage */
20:    $PV \leftarrow \text{SAMPLE}(SelectP, D)$ 
21:    $B \leftarrow \text{EXECUTE}(pgm, time_s, PV)$ 
22:    $TotalB \leftarrow TotalB \cup \{B\}$ 
23:    $D \leftarrow D \cup \{(p, v, B) \mid (p, v) \in PV\}$ 
24: until  $time$  expires
25: return  $UnionB$  ▷  $UnionB = \bigcup_{B \in TotalB} B$ 

```

Algorithm 1

- Initialize
 - D , $BaseD$, $TotalB$, $times$
- Extraction Stage
 - 전체 파라미터 후보 추출
 - --help로 parameter 이름 추출

p	파라미터 이름
vd	해당 파라미터의 default value
V	실험해볼 수 있는 possible values

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23:    $D \leftarrow D \cup \{(p, v, B) \mid (p, v) \in PV\}$ 
24: until  $time$  expires
25: return  $UnionB$  ▷  $UnionB = \bigcup_{B \in TotalB} B$ 

```

Algorithm 1

- Initialize
 - D , $BaseD$, $TotalB$, $times$
- Extraction Stage
 - 전체 파라미터 후보 추출
 - P : 파라미터 이름
 - vd : 그 파라미터의 default value
 - V : 실험해볼 수 있는 possible values
 - **Boolean/string 파라미터**
 - ParaSuit는 source code의 parameter definition block에서 가능한 후보 값을 직접 뽑는다.
 - **Integer/float 파라미터**
 - default value의 0.5배에서 1.5배 사이 값을 후보로 잡는다.

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 - P : 파라미터 이름
 - vd : 그 파라미터의 default value
 - V : 실험해볼 수 있는 possible values
 - Boolean/string 파라미터
 - Integer/float 파라미터
 - 불필요한 parameter filtering
 - log, version 과 같은 파라미터 제외

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Algorithm 1

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 - D, BaseD, TotalB, times
- Extraction Stage
 - 전체 파라미터 후보 추출
 - P: 파라미터 이름
 - vd: 그 파라미터의 default value
 - V: 실험해볼 수 있는 possible values
 - Boolean/string 파라미터
 - Integer/float 파라미터
 - 불필요한 parameter filtering
 - 파라미터의 단독 영향 평가
 - 한 번에 하나의 파라미터만 default가 아닌 값으로 바꾸고, 나머지는 모두 default로 둔 뒤 실행.

Algorithm 1 PARASUIT

Input: Program (pgm), time budget ($time$)

Output: A total set of covered branches ($UnionB$)

```

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24: until  $time$  expires
25: return  $UnionB$  ▷  $UnionB = \bigcup_{B \in TotalB} B$ 

```

Algorithm 1

- Initialize
 - D , $BaseD$, $TotalB$, $times$
- Extraction Stage
- **Selection Stage**
 - 어떤 파라미터를 이번 실행에서 튜닝할지 고르는 단계

```
BaseS ← { (p, Score(B, TotalB)) | (p, _, B) ∈ BaseD } // 파라미터 하나만 바꿨을 때 얼마나 좋은가
ParamS ← { (p, Score(B, TotalB)) | (p, _, B) ∈ D } // 다른 파라미터들과 함께 썼을 때 얼마나 좋은가
SelectP ← Select(ParamS, BaseS)
```

Algorithm 1 PARASUIT

Input: Program (pgm), time budget ($time$)

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24: until  $time$  expires
25: return  $UnionB$  ▷  $UnionB = \bigcup_{B \in TotalB} B$ 
```

Algorithm 2

- Initialize
 - D , BaseD, TotalB, times
- Extraction Stage
- Selection Stage
- **Sampling Stage**
 - **Explore**: 데이터가 부족하거나 cluster가 불안정할 때 다양한 값을 시도
 - **Exploit**: score가 좋은 cluster를 중심으로 값을 샘플링
 - mean shift clustering 사용
 - 선택된 파라미터 SelectP에 대해 실제 값을 샘플링

Algorithm 2 Value Sampling Stage

Input: Selected parameters ($SelectP$), data (D)

Output: Parameter values (PV)

```
1: procedure SAMPLE( $SelectP, D$ )
2:  $PV \leftarrow \emptyset$ 
3: for each  $p \in SelectP$  do
4:    $ValueS \leftarrow \{(v, Score(B', TotalB)) \mid (p = p') \wedge (p', v', B') \in D\}$ 
5:    $C \leftarrow Cluster(ValueS)$   $\triangleright C = \{C_1, C_2, \dots, C_n\}; C_i \subseteq ValueS$ 
6:   if Silhouette( $C$ )  $\leq \eta_{clust}$  then
7:      $PV \leftarrow PV \cup (p, Explore(ValueS))$   $\triangleright \eta_{clust} = 0.7$ 
8:   else
9:      $PV \leftarrow PV \cup (p, Exploit(C))$   $\triangleright C = \{C_1, C_2, \dots, C_n\}$ 
10: return  $PV$ 
```

Algorithm 1

- Initialize
 - D , $BaseD$, $TotalB$, $times$
- Extraction Stage
- Selection Stage
- Sampling Stage
- **Symbolic execution 실행**
 - ParaSuit는 새로 샘플링한 PV로 symbolic execution을 실행

Algorithm 1 PARASUIT

Input: Program (pgm), time budget ($time$)

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Algorithm 1

- Initialize
 - D , $BaseD$, $TotalB$, $times$
- Extraction Stage
- Selection Stage
- Sampling Stage
- Symbolic execution 실행
- 데이터 갱신

Algorithm 1 PARASUIT

Input: Program (pgm), time budget ($time$)

Output: A total set of covered branches ($UnionB$)

```
1:  $\langle D, BaseD, TotalB, times \rangle \leftarrow \langle \emptyset, \emptyset, \emptyset, \eta_{time} \rangle$  ▷  $\eta_{time} = 120$ 
2:
3: /* Step 1. Extraction stage */
4:  $P \leftarrow Initialize()$  ▷  $(p, v_d, V) \in P$ 
5: for each  $(p, v_d, V) \in P$  do
6:    $PV_d \leftarrow \{(p', v_d) \mid (p', v_d, \_) \in P \wedge (p \neq p')\}$ 
7:   for  $v$  in  $V \setminus \{v_d\}$  do
8:      $PV \leftarrow PV_d \cup \{(p, v)\}$ 
9:      $B \leftarrow EXECUTE(pgm, times, PV)$  ▷  $B$  = covered branches
10:     $BaseD \leftarrow BaseD \cup \{(p, v, B)\}$ 
11:     $TotalB \leftarrow TotalB \cup \{B\}$ 
12:
13: repeat
14:   /* Step 2. Parameter selection stage */
15:    $BaseS \leftarrow \{(p, Score(B, TotalB)) \mid (p, \_, B) \in BaseD\}$ 
16:    $ParamS \leftarrow \{(p, Score(B, TotalB)) \mid (p, \_, B) \in D\}$ 
17:    $SelectP \leftarrow Select(ParamS, BaseS)$ 
18:
19:   /* Step 3. Value sampling stage */
20:    $PV \leftarrow SAMPLE>SelectP, D)$ 
21:    $B \leftarrow EXECUTE(pgm, times, PV)$ 
22:    $TotalB \leftarrow TotalB \cup \{B\}$ 
23:    $D \leftarrow D \cup \{(p, v, B) \mid (p, v) \in PV\}$ 
24: until  $time$  expires
25: return  $UnionB$  ▷  $UnionB = \bigcup_{B \in TotalB} B$ 
```

Algorithm 1

- Initialize
 - D , $BaseD$, $TotalB$, $times$
- Extraction Stage
- Selection Stage
- Sampling Stage
- Symbolic execution 실행
- 데이터 갱신
- **UnionB 반환**
 - 모든 짧은 symbolic execution 실행에서 커버된 branch들을 합친 최종 branch coverage

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Experiments

Experiments

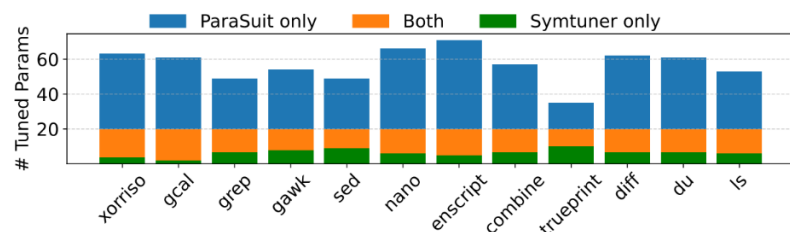
- Settings: 4 baselines
 - *KLEE_{fix}*, *Symtuner*, *Symtuner_{AHP}*, *Randsuit*
- Benchmark
- Tool: KLEE-2.1
- Benchmarks: 12 GNU C programs
- Budget: 24 hours
- Repetitions: 5 trials
- Metric: branch coverage, unique bugs
- Coverage measurement: gcov

Program	LoC	Branches
xorriso-1.5.2	161K	49,162
gcal-4.1	89K	15,799
grep-3.4	82K	8,225
gawk-5.1.0	77K	10,720
sed-4.8	66K	6,798
nano-4.9	54K	10,436
enscript-1.6.6	49K	3,796
combine-0.4.0	32K	2,357
trueprint-5.4	12K	2,518
diff-3.7	9K	7,612
du-8.32	8K	6,653
ls-8.32	5K	3,776

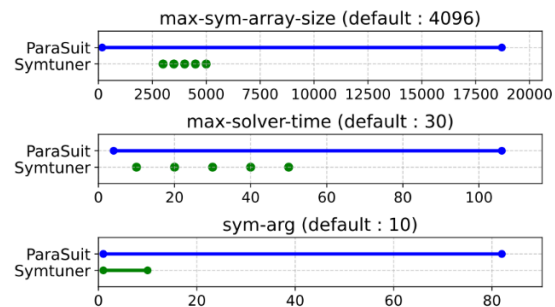
Benchmark

Branch Coverage

- $KLEE_{fix}$ 보다 97.4%
- $Symtuner$ 보다 25.8%
- $Symtuner_{AIIIP}$ 보다 95.6%
- $Randsuit$ 보다 46.8%



(a) The difference in the parameter selection.



(b) The difference in the value sampling.

Table 2: Branch coverage achieved by PARASUIT and four baselines on 12 benchmarks.

Benchmark	PARASUIT	SYMTUNER	KLEE _{fix}	RANDSUIT	SYMTUNER _{AIIIP}
xorriso-1.5.2	6,109.4	2,956.8	2,014.8	2,272.8	2,117.6
gcal-4.1	4,766.0	3,907.0	2,003.2	3,234.6	1,825.0
grep-3.4	3,613.8	3,280.2	2,208.4	3,344.2	2,017.8
gawk-5.1.0	4,393.2	3,747.0	2,841.6	2,893.0	3,261.8
sed-4.8	2,462.6	2,357.8	1,097.0	1,840.8	1,267.6
nano-4.9	1,909.6	1,721.0	1,457.0	1,662.2	1,289.0
enscript-1.6.6	776.4	734.2	580.8	688.8	448.6
combine-0.4.0	1,004.6	952.4	644.8	835.6	463.4
trueprint-5.4	1,300.2	1,019.2	579.0	881.6	571.2
diff-3.7	2,139.0	1,762.2	538.4	1,462.4	1,034.2
du-8.32	1,238.6	1,190.6	829.2	1,187.8	814.0
ls-8.32	2,165.4	1,712.0	1,355.2	1,410.4	1,185.8
total	31,878.8	25,340.4	16,149.4	21,714.2	16,296.0

Bug-finding ability

- A bug-triggering test-case was considered unique if its error location reported by KLEE differed from others
- Parasuit succeeded in detecting 11 unique bugs across three of the 12 programs: gcal, gawk, and combine. (SYMTUNER 보다 더 좋은 성능.)

Table 3: Number of bugs detected by PARASUIT and baselines.

Benchmark	PARASUIT	SYMTUNER	KLEE _{fix}	RANDSUIT	SYMTUNER _{AllP}
gcal	7	4	4	2	1
gawk	1	1	-	1	-
combine	3	2	1	1	1
total	11	7	5	4	3

Efficacy of two stages

- Parameter selection stage
(xorriso, gcal, grep) with (gcal, gawk, combine)
RandP, AllP, SymP보다 각각 60.2%, 89.9%, 34.2% 더 높은 coverage
- Value sampling algorithm
 - CMA-ES보다 **11.0%**, RandV보다 **21.5%**, SymV보다 49.0% 더 높은 coverage

$$BaseS \leftarrow \{(p, \text{Score}(B, \text{Total}B)) \mid (p, _, B) \in BaseD\}$$

$$ParamS \leftarrow \{(p, \text{Score}(B, \text{Total}B)) \mid (p, _, B) \in D\}$$

Table 4: Effectiveness of our parameter selection stage compared with naive selection approaches.

Benchmark	PARASUIT	RANDP	SYMP	ALLP
xorriso	6,109(0)	2,615(0)	3,149(0)	2,426(0)
gcal	4,766(7)	3,578(2)	4,160(3)	3,105(2)
grep	3,614(0)	2,852(0)	3,404(0)	1,749(0)
gawk	4,393(1)	2,551(0)	3,336(1)	2,521(1)
combine	1,005(3)	861(1)	953(2)	577(1)
total	19,887(11)	12,457(3)	15,002(6)	10,378(4)

Table 5: The efficiency of the value sampling algorithm compared with five sampling methods.

Benchmark	PARASUIT	BAYESIAN	GENETIC	CMA-ES	RANDV	SYMV
xorriso	6,109(0)	4,417(0)	4,383(0)	5,361(0)	3,759(0)	2,745(0)
gcal	4,766(7)	4,617(5)	4,552(5)	4,412(5)	4,421(4)	3,642(2)
grep	3,614(0)	3,559(0)	3,349(0)	3,455(0)	3,407(0)	3,414(0)
gawk	4,393(1)	4,116(1)	3,902(0)	3,801(1)	3,920(0)	2,694(0)
combine	1,005(3)	883(1)	922(1)	892(2)	868(1)	856(1)
total	19,887(11)	17,592(7)	17,108(6)	17,921(8)	16,375(5)	13,351(3)

Analysis of self-configuration

- Impact of Selected Parameters
- Tendency of Selections and Sampled Values
- Efficiency of Self-configured Parameter Sets

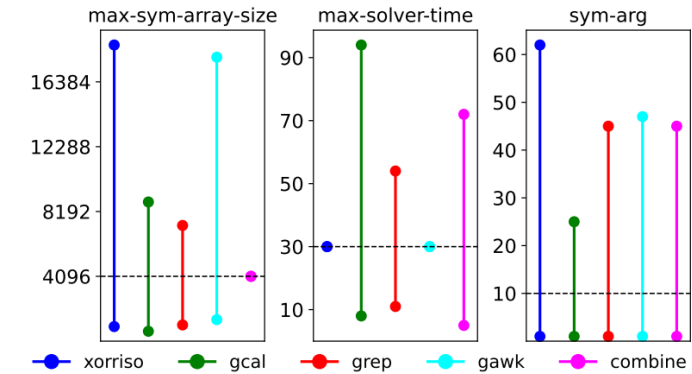


Figure 5: Integer parameter values sampled by PARASUIT.

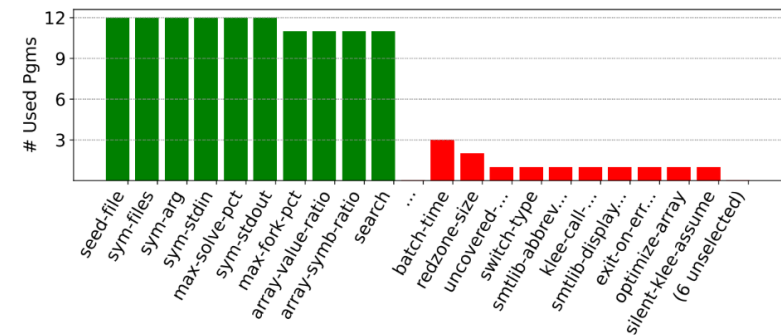


Figure 4: The count of benchmarks where each parameter was chosen at least once.

Generality

- 다른 symbolic/concolic testing 도구에도 적용 가능한지
- ParaSuit + Chameleon은 Chameleon 단독보다 평균 3.5배 더 많은 unique branches를 커버
- 총 6개 distinct bugs 발견
- vim과 sed에서 추가 bug 발견

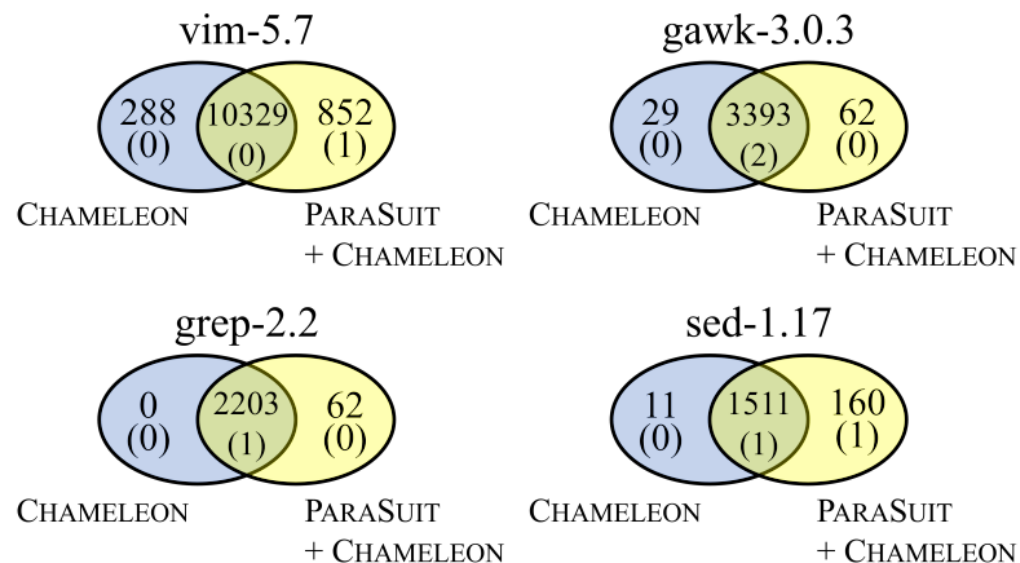


Figure 6: Efficacy of parameter tuning for concolic testing.

Threats to Validity

- ParaSuit는 두 개의 hyper-parameter를 사용
- benchmark가 12개 C 프로그램으로 제한

Conclusion

- 사용자 개입 없이 symbolic execution 파라미터를 처음부터 최적화하는 최초의 Self-configuring 기술 제안.
- 타겟 프로그램에 대한 symbolic execution feedback을 기반으로 파라미터를 자동 선택·샘플링.
- 다양한 벤치마크에서 branch coverage 대폭 향상 및 기존에 놓쳤던 고유 버그들을 발견.

Thank You
